own national homeland; it sounds like a moral solution—provided the separation is fair and the homelands are viable." In building his case, Sparks recalled how the apartheid planners had also denied demographic realities in their dream of a white South Africa. But eventually, he reminds us, they had to face the truth.[37]

In a series of articles resulting from a visit to the region, Sparks reinforced the South African paradigm. After meeting in Damascus with Musa Abu Marzook, deputy to Hamas's Damascus-based Khalid Mashaal, he reported that he found the Hamas man to be a pragmatist. Hamas's call for a *hudna*, or truce, which could prepare the way for a settlement, made great sense to Sparks.

> The mutual recognition of a stalemate, or what we South Africans back in the 1980s called a "violent equilibrium," has been identified by political analysts as a crucial first step towards resolving national conflicts of this kind. Thereafter, as the South African experience showed, events can sometimes start generating their own momentum.

Underpinning this critique is a comparison of Palestinian life with that of blacks under apartheid. "The whole matrix is vividly reminiscent of South Africa's Bantustan dispensation, although Israelis vigorously resist any such comparison," he explains. "I travelled extensively through the West Bank, talking to Palestinians and experiencing what they go through every day, and I am convinced it is neither a viable homeland nor a bearable existence for them."[38]

The mantra of non-racism in the "new South Africa," its opposition to ethnic politics, its powerful anti-colonialism, its support for the underdog, and the much-vaunted success of South Africa's so-called "miracle" all add popular weight to these views. If South Africa could pull itself back from the chasm and avoid a racial conflagration, why can the Jews and Palestinians not do the same? South Africans have great confidence in talking, consulting and negotiating—"the South African way," as some observers have put it. More than that, South Africans negotiated a constitution that was inclusive, but respectful of cultural and religious diversity. Surely this can be replicated by Israelis and Palestinians?

*****

For many South Africans (including some leftist Jews), what exists in Israel is an anachronistic ethnic state.[39] The "ethnic state" echoes Afrikaner dreams and builds upon exploited cheap Palestinian labour. Within this paradigm, the Palestinian struggle is framed as anti-colonial resistance. But the parallels are

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,